

FEMA National Watch Center

Daily Operations Briefing

Friday, September 18, 2026

8:30 a.m. ET



FEMA

National Current Operations / Monitoring

New Significant Incidents / Ongoing Operations:

- No new significant incidents / operations

Hazard Monitoring:

- Heavy Rain / Flash Flooding – Upper Mississippi Valley, Midwest
- Tropical Activity:
 - Atlantic:
 - Disturbance 1: Low (30%)
 - Disturbance 2 (AL98): Low (near 0%)
 - Eastern and Central Pacific:
 - Disturbance 1 (EP98): High (80%)
 - Disturbance 2: Med (40%)
 - Disturbance 3: High (80%)

Disaster Declaration Activity:

- No new declaration activity

Event Monitoring:

- 81st United Nations General Assembly – New York



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81st Session of the United Nations General Assembly – New York City, NY

Situation: The 81st Session of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) has been designated a National Special Security Event (NSSE) by the Secretary of the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) for the period of Sep 20 through Sep 26. FEMA is the lead federal agency responsible for emergency and consequence management planning and coordination.

State / Local Response:

- NY SEOC at Normal Operations
- NYC EOC at Normal Operations

FEMA / Federal Response

FEMA Region 2:

- Watch is Monitoring; RRCC will activate (day shift only) on Sep 22
- Regional LNO's deployed to FBI IOC, NYPD JOC, UN JOC, and USSS MACC
- R-IMAT, Pre-designated FCO, and Defense Coordinating Elements on Alert

FEMA HQ:

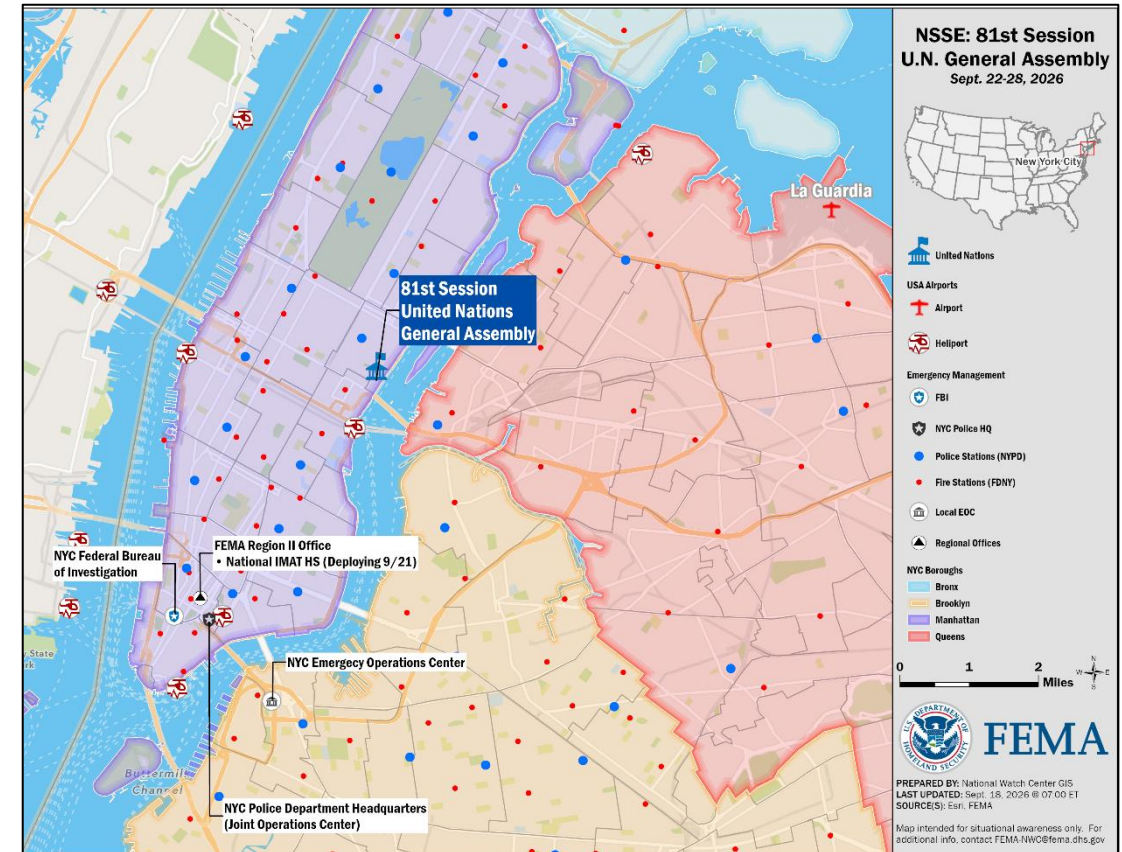
- NWC is Monitoring
- NRCC at Steady State; NRCS BLUE Team on Alert
- National IMAT HS will deploy to FEMA Region 2 on Sep 21 at 7:00 a.m. ET
- CMCU and DEST on alert

MERS:

- MERS will provide communications and mobile command functions to FEMA Region 2 and other Federal agencies as directed

US&R:

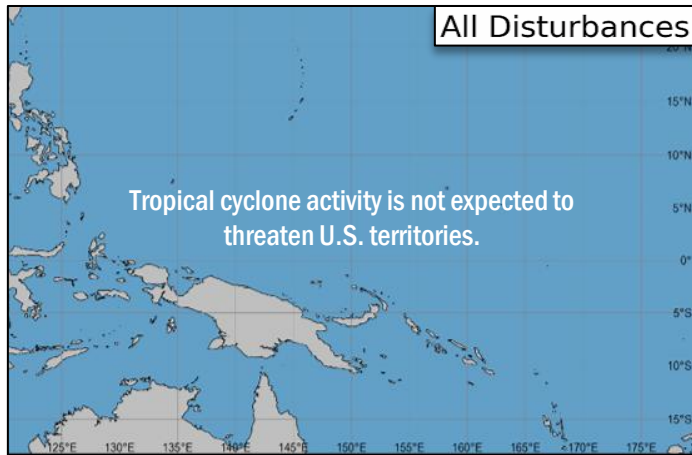
- Will issue an ESF #9 Advisory



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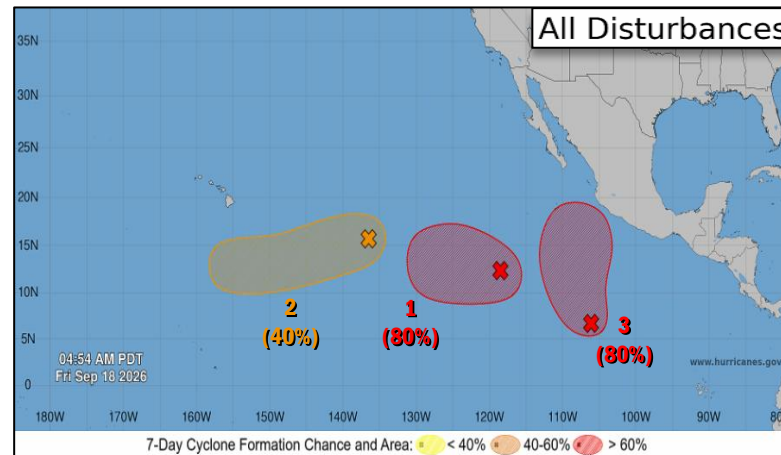
Tropical Outlook

Western Pacific



- Tropical cyclone activity is not expected to threaten U.S. territories.

Eastern and Central Pacific



Disturbance 1 (EP98): (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Located SW of southern tip of Baja California Peninsula
- Moving W at 10-15 mph
- Environmental conditions appear conducive for additional development; a tropical depression is likely to form this weekend
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Medium (60%); 7-day: High (80%)

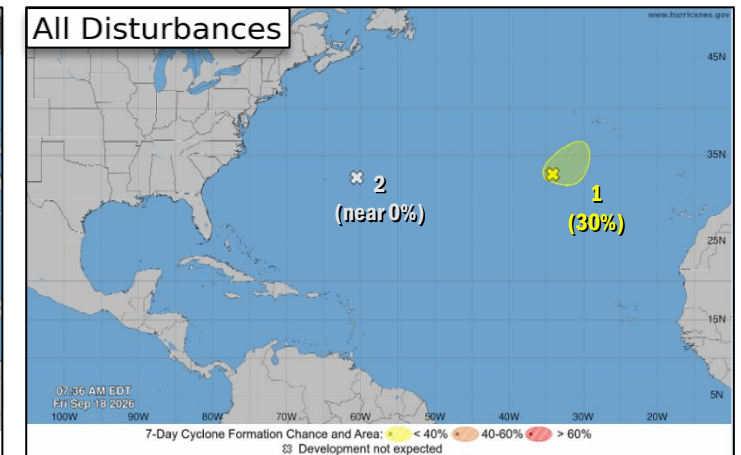
Disturbance 2: (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Located more than 1,000 miles ESE of the Hawaiian Islands
- Moving W to WSW
- Environmental conditions conducive for some development
- Remains well ESE of the Hawaiian Islands
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (10%); 7-day: Med (40%)

Disturbance 3: (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 800 miles SSW of southwestern Mexico
- Moving NNW
- Environmental conditions remain conducive for gradual development; a tropical depression is likely to form late this weekend or early next week
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (20%); 7-day: High (80%)

Atlantic



Disturbance 1: (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Located several hundred miles SW of the Azores
- Moving E
- Conditions appear marginally favorable for additional development
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (20%); 7-day: Low (30%)

Disturbance 2 (AL98): (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

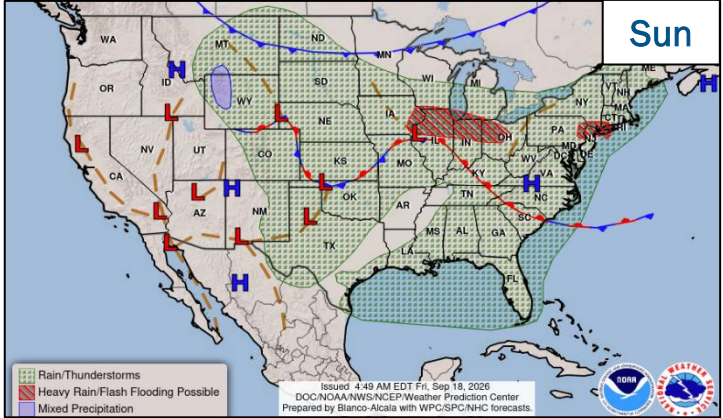
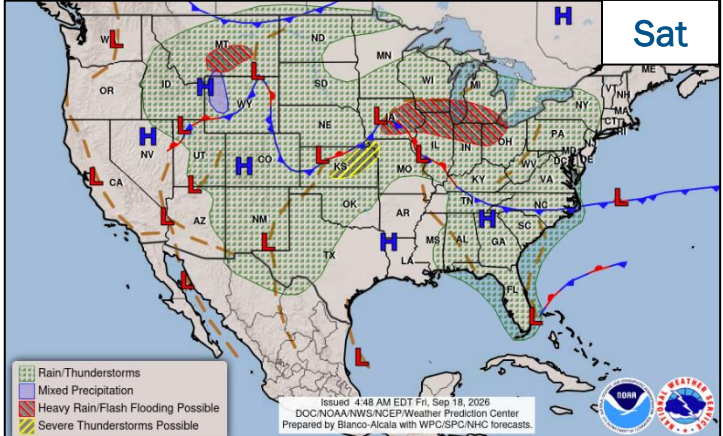
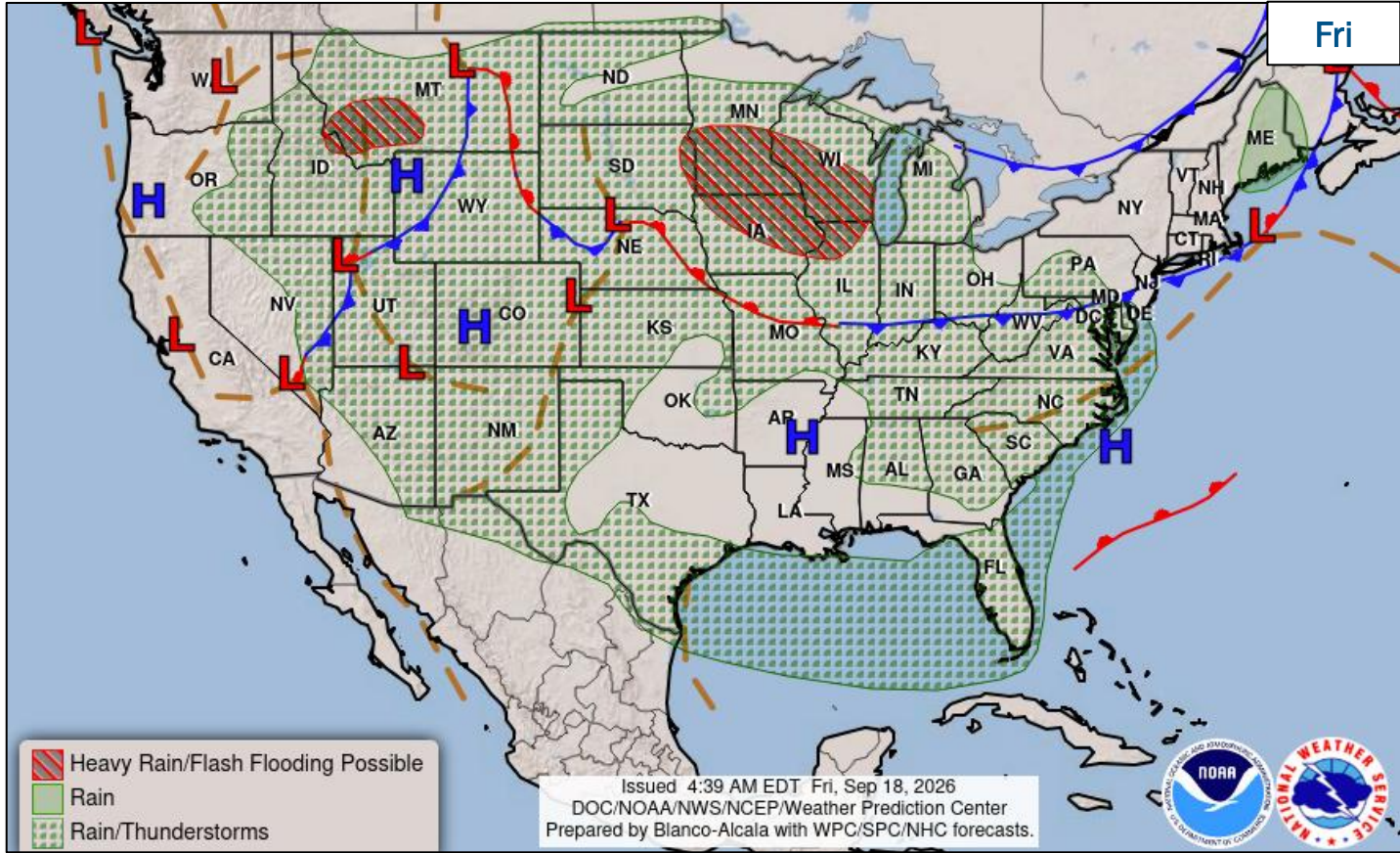
- Located a few hundred miles E of Bermuda
- Development is no longer expected as it drifts slowly over the subtropical Atlantic during the next day or so
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (near 0%); 7-day: Low (near 0%)



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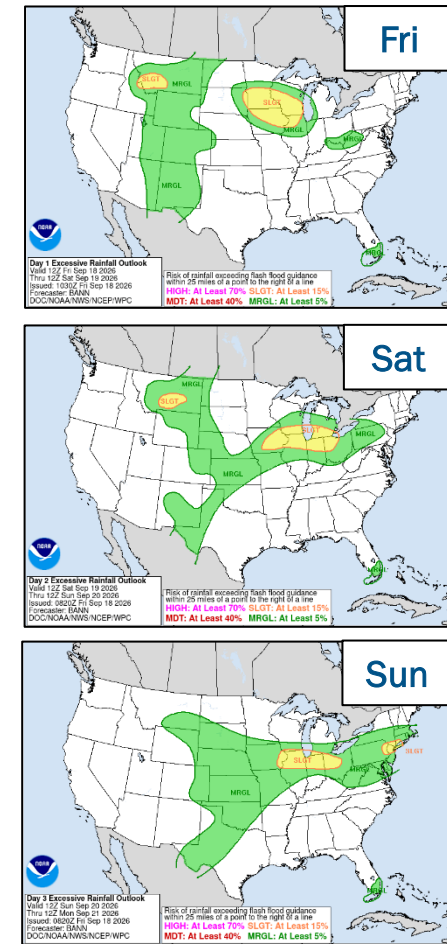
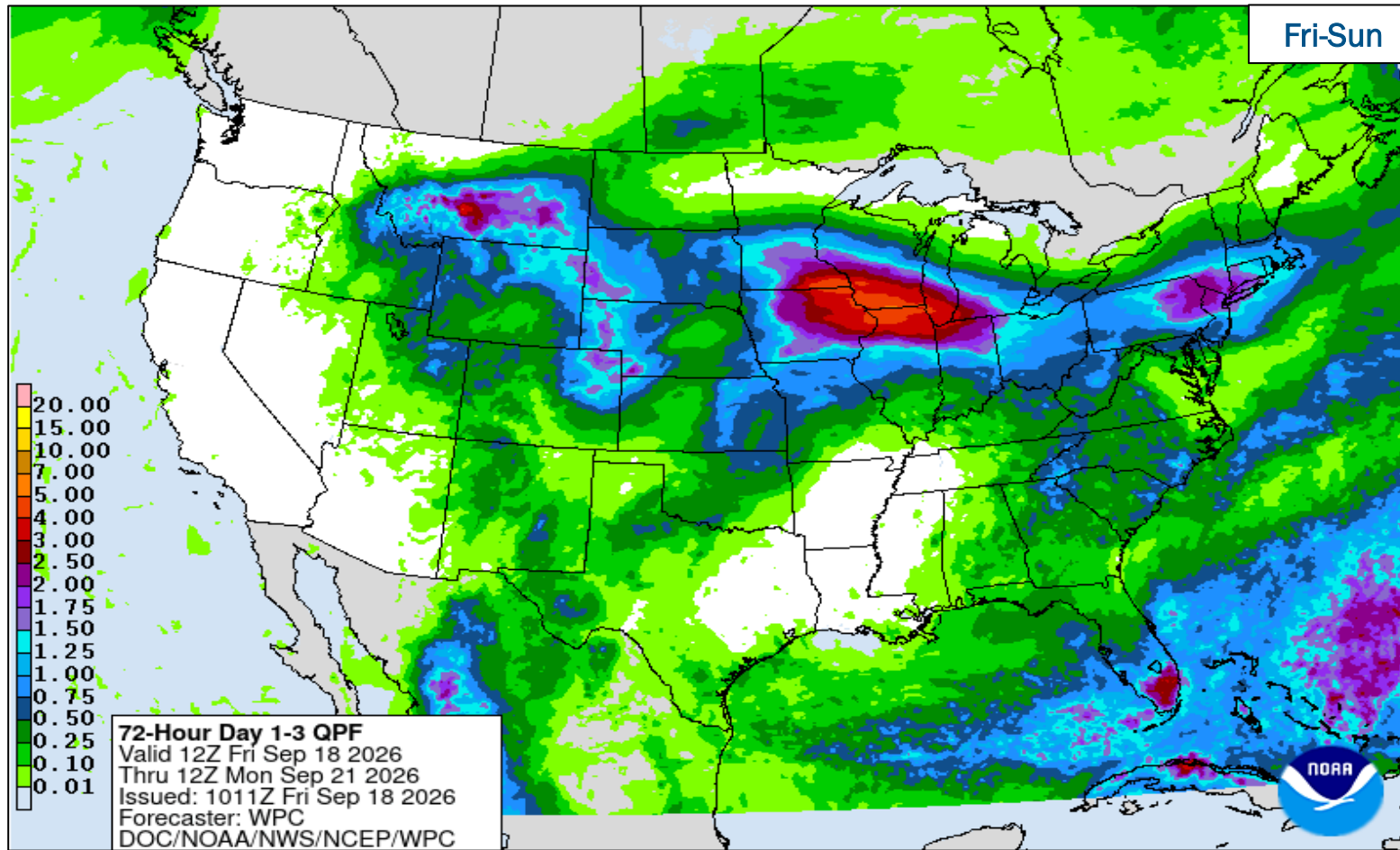
National Weather Forecast



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Precipitation & Excessive Rainfall

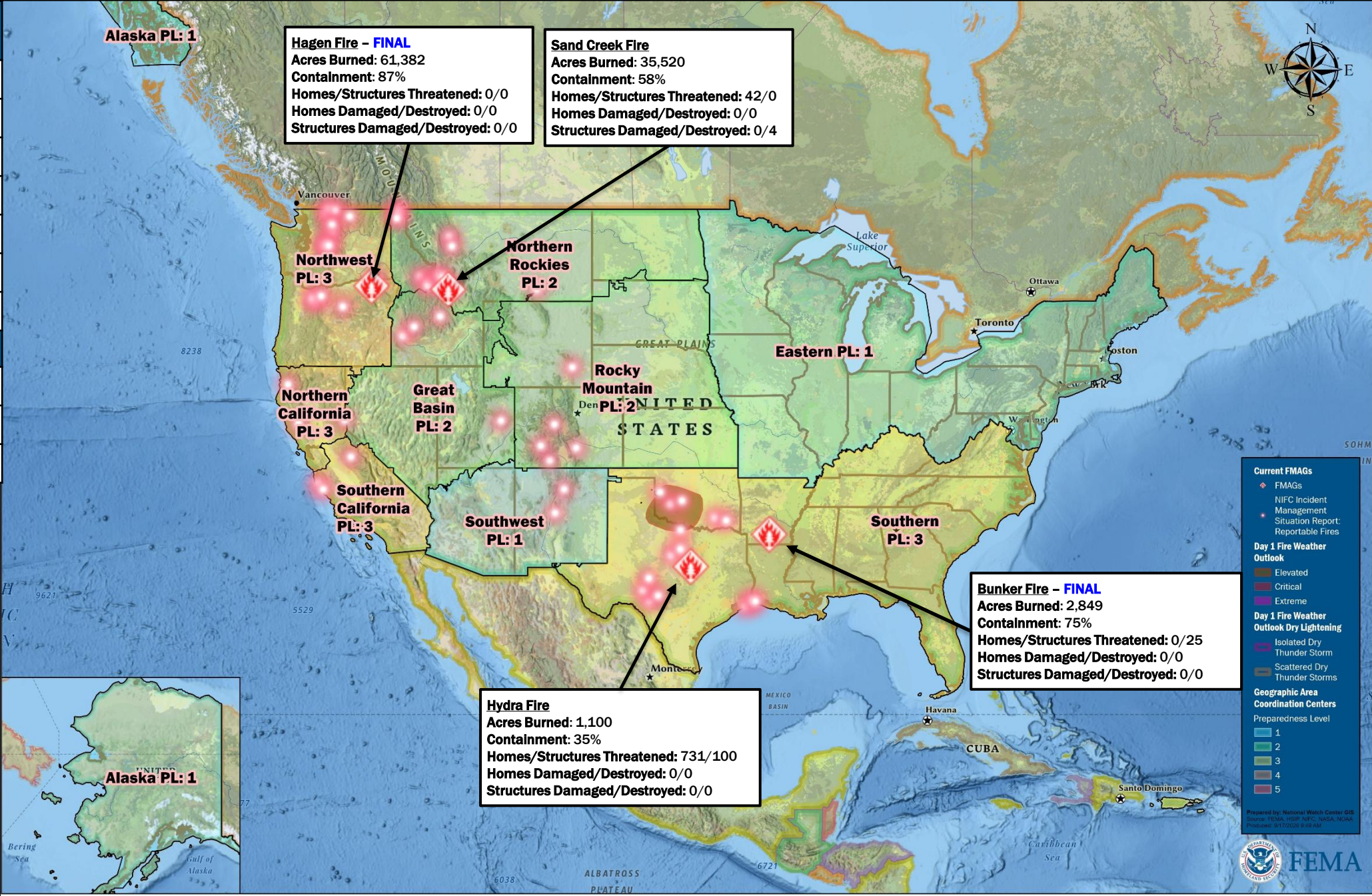


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INITIAL ATTACK ACTIVITY (24-hour period)	Light (86 fires)
New Large Fires	8
Large Fires Contained	6
Uncontained Large Fires	56
Year-to-Date Acres Burned	8,515,617
Total Responders	12,047
Type 1 IMTs Deployed	0
Complex IMTs Deployed	11
FMAGS	Total
2026 (FYTD)	63
2025	75
3 Year Average	53

Preparedness Levels:	
PL 1	Minimal fire activity; many resources available
PL 2	Large wildland fires burning throughout country; resources mobilized from other areas
PL 3	Wildfire activity ongoing throughout 25% of country; National Interagency Coordination Center (NICC) sets priorities, allocates resources, and mobilizes assets at national level
PL 4	High levels of fire activity and areas are competing for firefighting resources; 60% of the nation's wildland firefighting resources committed
PL 5	Extremely high levels of fire activity; 80% of nation's firefighting resources committed



Wildfire Summary

Fire Name (County, ST)	FMAG #	Acres Burned	Percent Contained	Evacuations	Structures (Homes / Other)			Fatalities / Injuries
					Threatened	Damaged	Destroyed	
Hagen (Umatilla/Union, OR) FINAL	5664-FM-OR	61,382 (+1)	87%	3,585	H: 0 (-42)	H: 0	H: 0	0 / 12
					O: 0 (-17)	O: 0	O: 0	
Sand Creek (Beaverhead, MT)	5671-FM-MT	35,520	58%	LIFTED	H: 42	H: 0	H: 0	0 / 7
					O: 0	O: 0	O: 4	
Bunker Fire (Calhoun, AR) FINAL	5676-FM-AR	2,849 (+12)	75% (+10)	200	H: 0 (-200)	H: 0	H: 0	0 / 0
					O: 25 (+17)	O: 0	O: 0	
Hydra (Bosque, TX)	5677-FM-TX	1,100	35% (+10)	1,400	H: 731	H: 0	H: 0	0 / 1
					O: 100	O: 0	O: 0	

Structures: H = Homes and Mixed Commercial/Residential / O = Non-residential Commercial/Other Minor Structures)



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FEMA Common Operating Picture

National Watch Center

Incident Workforce

18,864
Assigned a Disaster Title

6,256 / 33%
Deployed

6,154 / 33%
Available to Deploy for 30 Days

6,454 / 34%
Remaining

Surge Capacity Force
7,702 / 0 / 770
Rostered / Deployed /
Est. Available to Deploy for 30 Days

Friday,
September 18, 2026
8:30 a.m. ET

National Readiness

National Watch Center

NRCC

N-IMAT Red

N-IMAT White

N-IMAT Blue

N-IMAT Gold

N-IMAT HS

National Notes

National Watch Center:
• Staffing

NRCC:
• Rostered

National IMATs:
• N-IMAT Red: Demobilizing 9/18; Reconstituting until 9/25
• N-IMAT White: Staffing
• N-IMAT Blue: Staffing

REGIONAL BREAKDOWN

	JFO	DR	EM	JRO
R1	0	1	0	0
R2	0	0	0	2
R3	0	2	0	0
R4	4	14	0	1
R5	0	3	0	0
R6	4	7	3	3
R7	0	9	0	0
R8	0	9	1	0
R9	1	6	6	0
R10	4	7	1	0



CNMI
DR-4910-MP &
EM-3647-MP
• R9 IMAT-2

Guam
DR-4921-GU &
EM-3648-GU
• ISB Delta

Hawaii
DR-4936-HI, DR-4909-HI
& EM-3652-HI
• R9 IMAT-1
• N IMAT-RED (Demob on 9/18)

Camp Murray, WA
EM-3650-WA
• R10 IMAT

Pine Ridge, SD
DR-4941-OST
• R8 IMAT

Indianapolis, IN
DR-4933-IN
EM-3651-IN
• R5 IMAT

South Carolina
DR-4829-SC
DR-4835-SC
DR-4858-SC
DR-4908-SC
Closing 9/18

- FEMA Headquarters
- Regional Offices
- National IMAT
- Regional IMAT
- Incident Support Base
- Staging Management Team
- Distribution Center
- Open Joint Field Offices
- Recovery Support Function Activations
- Joint Recovery Office
- Direct Housing Missions
- FMAGs
- Large Fires
- State Activation Levels
- Full
- Partial
- Monitoring
- Normal
- Declared Counties

Regional Readiness

Watch RRCC IMAT

Region 1

Region 2

Region 3

Region 4

Region 5

Region 6

Region 7

Region 8

Region 9

Region 10

Regional Notes

Watches/RRCCs:
• R2 Watch: Equipment
• R5 Watch: Staffing
• R9 Watch: Severe Weather
• R10 RRCC: Staffing

State EOCs:
• FL/MS/TN: Previous Incidents
• AK/AR/CO/ID/NV/OK/TX/UT/WA: Wildfires
• IL/KY: Severe Weather
• MP: TC Bavi/Saudel
• PR/VA: Drought
• IN: 4933-DR-IN/3651-EM-IN
• HI: TC Lowell

IMATs:
• R1: Staffing
• R3: Staffing
• R4-1/2: Staffing
• R5: 3651-EM-IN
• R7: Requires Augmentation
• R8: 4941-DR-OST
• R9-1: 3652-EM-HI/4909-DR-HI/4936-DR-HI
• R9-2: 4910-DR-MP
• R10: 3650-EM-WA

Legend

Commodities & Equipment

SMT

MERS Det.

US&R

FCO

	CONUS	Caribbean	Hawaii	Guam
Water				
Meals				
Generators				

Operational	11/11
Requires Augmentation	3/11
Deployed	2/11

30/36 Operational	
Maynard	4/6
Frederick	6/6
Thomasville	6/6
Denton	6/6
Denver	4/6
Bothell	4/6

Task Forces	
Assigned	28
Non-FEMA Deployed	0
FEMA-Deployed	0
Not Mission Capable	0
Available	28
FEMA Support Staff	11/21

Assigned	38
Not Mission Capable	1
Deployed	32 (29 FCO)
Available	5

Joint Preliminary Damage Assessments

Region	State / Location	Event	IA	Number of Counties		Start – End
			PA	Requested	Complete	
R5	OH	Severe Weather and Flooding Aug 11 and continuing	IA	0	0	N/A
			PA	22	1	9/15 – TBD
R10	AK	Mukluk Fire Aug 21-25	IA	1	0	9/21 – TBD
			PA	1	0	9/21 – TBD



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Declaration Requests in Process – 15

State / Tribe / Territory – Incident Description	Type	IA	PA	HM	Requested
NH – Severe Storm and Flash Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Jul 8
IN – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Aug 6
GU – Super Typhoon Bavi	DR	X	X	X	Aug 11
MN – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Aug 20
UT – Cottonwood Fire, Flooding, and Mudslides	DR		X	X	Aug 22
WI – Severe Storms and Tornado	DR	X	X	X	Aug 26
WV – Severe Storm, Flooding, Landslides, and Mudslides – Appeal	DR	X		X	Aug 31
NE – Severe Storm, Straight-line Winds, and Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Aug 31
OH – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, Flooding, and Landslides	DR	X		X	Sep 2
OK – Severe Storms and Straight-line Winds	DR		X	X	Sep 2
TN – Severe Storm and Straight-line Winds	DR	X	X	X	Sep 8
HI – Hurricane Lala	DR	X	X	X	Sep 8
HI – Hurricane Lowell	DR	X	X	X	Sep 9
WV – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Sep 12
IL – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Sep 15



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Helping people before, during, and after disasters.



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